



## **Subject Vision and Intent: RE**

### **Our Vision**

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that Religious Education helps children understand the beliefs, worldviews and experiences that shape people's lives. Our ambition is for children to leave KCA knowledgeable and curious about religion and worldviews, able to engage thoughtfully with questions of belief, meaning and identity, and confident in discussing these with respect.

Our diverse community provides a particularly rich context for Religious Education. Children learn alongside people whose families may hold a wide range of religious and non-religious worldviews. We want children to recognise and appreciate this diversity while extending their knowledge beyond their immediate experiences and avoiding assumptions about what an individual might believe based upon their background or identity.

Our RE curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Children encounter different ways in which people understand the world, ask important questions and learn from the experiences and perspectives of others. RE provides particularly powerful opportunities to develop our KCA values of Respect, Kindness and Integrity, while giving children the courage to ask difficult questions and express their own ideas thoughtfully.

### **Our Intent**

Our RE curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary, concepts and questions we want children to encounter from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to develop increasingly rich and connected understanding of religious and non-religious worldviews.

Children develop knowledge of different religions and worldviews through their beliefs, practices, stories, traditions, communities and lived experiences. Learning is deliberately built over time so that children revisit and deepen important ideas, make connections between what they have learned and develop increasingly sophisticated understanding.

Children encounter sacred texts, stories, artefacts, places of worship, celebrations and practices, considering what these mean to the people and communities for whom they are significant. They learn appropriate vocabulary so that they can describe and discuss religion and worldviews accurately and respectfully.

Our curriculum helps children understand that religions and worldviews are lived as well as studied. People may share a religious or non-religious worldview while expressing, interpreting and practising it in different ways. Children therefore encounter diversity both between and within traditions and learn to avoid treating any community as though all of its members think and behave in exactly the same way.

Alongside developing secure knowledge, children learn to ask increasingly thoughtful questions about meaning, belief, identity, morality, belonging and how people understand the world. They consider different responses to these questions and learn to make connections between beliefs and the ways in which people choose to live.

Discussion and reflection are important parts of RE. Children are encouraged to articulate their thinking, explain their ideas, listen carefully to others and respond respectfully when perspectives differ. We want children to understand that respectful discussion does not require everyone to agree, but it does require people to listen, question thoughtfully and treat the beliefs and ideas of others with dignity.

Children are also given opportunities to reflect upon their own ideas and values. RE does not seek to tell children what they should believe; rather, it provides the knowledge and space through which they can encounter significant questions, understand different responses and develop their own thinking.

## **Every Child**

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious RE curriculum.

Teachers identify the essential knowledge, vocabulary and concepts that all children need and adapt teaching so that barriers are reduced without lowering expectations. Stories, artefacts, images, carefully structured discussion, explicit vocabulary teaching and opportunities to revisit important knowledge support children in developing secure understanding.

We recognise that children's prior experiences of religion and worldviews vary considerably. Some children may participate actively in a religious community, others may encounter religion primarily through family or cultural traditions, and others may have little direct experience of religion. We do not assume prior knowledge and ensure that the curriculum provides every child with the foundations they need.

Children's own beliefs and family experiences are treated with sensitivity and respect. No child is expected to speak on behalf of a religion, worldview or community because of their own or their family's identity. Children may contribute personal experiences when they choose, but these experiences complement rather than replace the knowledge taught through the curriculum.

## **RE Beyond the Curriculum**

Our commitment to understanding religion and worldviews extends beyond the classroom. Where appropriate, children have opportunities to visit places of worship and encounter

members of religious and non-religious communities, allowing them to connect what they learn with lived experience.

Our location in London provides children with opportunities to encounter an extraordinary range of communities, traditions, buildings and cultural institutions. These experiences help children recognise religion and worldviews as living parts of the communities around them rather than simply topics encountered within a lesson.

Visits and encounters are carefully connected to curriculum learning. They provide opportunities for children to observe, ask questions, deepen their knowledge and understand how beliefs and traditions can be expressed in people's everyday lives.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is not simply that children can recall facts about different religions and worldviews. We want them to understand some of the beliefs and ideas that shape people's lives, recognise diversity within and between traditions, ask informed questions and discuss matters of religion and belief with knowledge, curiosity and respect.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA as knowledgeable, thoughtful and respectful learners who are comfortable encountering beliefs different from their own and equipped to participate positively in the diverse society in which they live.